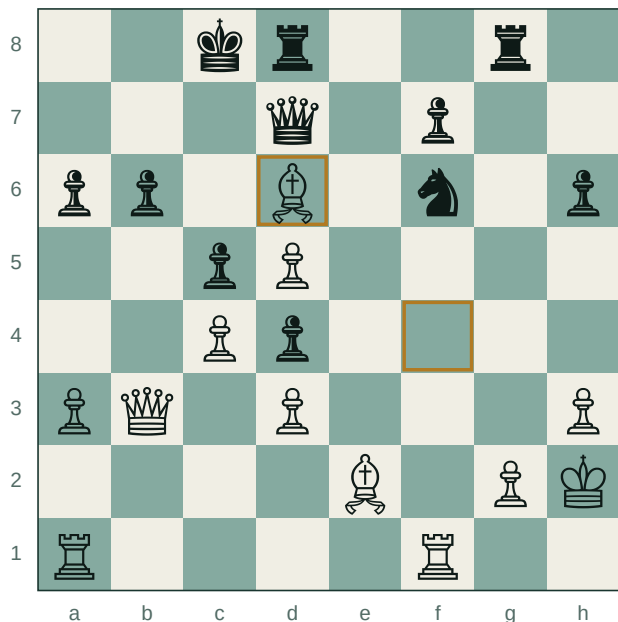


Attraction tactics: Black, move 21

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 21.Bxd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Qxd6+ 22. Kg1 Rxd6+ 23. Kxd6 Rg8+ 24. Bg4+ Nxd6

21...Qxd6+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on d6. Recorded reply: **22.Kg1**.

22...Rxd6+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From g2 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on e2. Recorded reply: **23.Kxd6**.

23...Rg8+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **24.Bg4+**.

24...Nxd6 The knight captures the bishop on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from -3 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d6 and queen on b3. Check for tactical protection.